First News

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DA Market Securities, Inc. | Employing Intelligent Investing

DAMS Research

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GLOBAL & REGIONAL MARKETS

Wall Street finished mostly higher on Friday, with both the S&P 500 and Nasdaq closing at fresh all-time records. A massive tech-led rally, fueled primarily by a surge in semiconductor stocks, propelled these gains even as the Dow slipped slightly. AMD surged 13% on Friday to $346 (from Thursday's $305.33 close), extending a rally that has pushed the stock up 63% over the past month. Intel's blowout Q1 earnings beat — stronger EPS and revenue than expected — and bullish Q2 guidance projecting revenue well above Street estimates ignited the entire chip sector as rising AI server CPU demand drives momentum. The S&P 500 rose 0.80% to 7,165, the Nasdaq surged 1.63% to 24,836, while the Dow edged down 0.16% to 49,230.

Oil prices paused and consolidated as renewed hopes for US-Iran peace talks suggested a potential return of steady energy flows through the Strait of Hormuz. WTI fell 1.5% to settle above $94/bbl after the White House said it was sending two envoys to Pakistan with the intention of talking with Iranian officials also slated to be in Islamabad. Brent settled at $105.33/bbl. However, the Iran war continues to disrupt global mining supply chains, restricting access to essential inputs and driving up production costs for aluminium, copper, nickel, iron ore, diesel, and helium.

In Asia, the Nikkei 225 hit another all-time high at 59,716 (+0.97%) as AI stocks led the charge after Intel's strong guidance ignited the tech sector. However, the broader Topix underperformed as Middle East tensions and inflation worries weighed on sentiment. Japan's core CPI accelerated to 1.8% in March. The Kospi was flat at 6,476; Hang Seng slipped 0.16%; China's CSI 300 fell 0.35%.

Domestically, the BSP's 25-bp hike to 4.5% — its first tightening since October 2023 — reverberated through local markets. Deutsche Bank and ANZ Research now expect 50 bps of additional hikes (June and August), bringing the terminal rate to 5.0%. Business confidence plunged to -24.3% in March, the weakest in over 25 years. The peso slipped 0.5% to ₱60.76/$ after the central bank hinted at modest rate hikes; the weakness reflects growth worries and BSP's limited intervention signal. Asian FX was down 0.1% broadly. The DBM ordered all government agencies to cut discretionary spending by 20% to fund the UPLIFT crisis package.

Asia-Pacific & U.S. Equity Indices

Index	4/24/2026	4/25/2026	%Chg
Dow Jones	49,310	49,230	-0.16%
S&P 500	7,108	7,165	+0.80%
NASDAQ	24,438	24,836	+1.63%
PCOMP (PSEi)	5,983	5,943	-0.67%
Nikkei 225	59,140	59,716	+0.97%
SHCOMP	4,093	4,079	-0.34%
Hang Seng	25,915	25,874	-0.16%
KOSPI	6,475	6,476	+0.02%
SENSEX	77,664	77,143	-0.67%
TWSE	37,714	37,550	-0.43%
ASX 200	8,793	8,787	-0.07%
BURSA KLCI	1,721	1,718	-0.17%
JCI (Jakarta)	7,378	7,360	-0.24%
STI (Singapore)	4,944	4,930	-0.28%
SET (Bangkok)	959	956	-0.31%
VNINDEX	1,870	1,862	-0.43%

Commodities

Commodity	4/24/2026	4/25/2026	%Chg
WTI Crude ($/bbl)	96.94	94.4	-2.62%
Brent Crude ($/bbl)	106.39	105.33	-1.00%
Gold COMEX ($/oz)	4714	4741	+0.57%
Silver COMEX ($/oz)	76.2	76.41	+0.28%
Copper COMEX (¢/lb)	610.2	602.7	-1.23%
Nickel ($/MT)	8.36	8.47	+1.32%
Coal ($/MT)	132.25	130.5	-1.32%
Corn (¢/bu)	463.5	465	+0.32%
Wheat (¢/bu)	619	622	+0.48%
Cocoa ($/MT)	3458	3440	-0.52%
Sugar (¢/lb)	13.89	13.95	+0.43%

FX & Fixed Income

	4/23/2026	4/24/2026	%Chg
PHL 10yr Bond (%)	6.675	6.71	+0.52%
US 10yr Bond (%)	4.327	4.31	-0.39%
USD-PHP	60.495	60.7	+0.34%
USD-JPY	159.4	159.33	-0.04%
EUR-USD	1.1711	1.1726	+0.13%

PSE MARKET SUMMARY — Friday, April 24, 2026

The PSEi closed at 5,943.49 on Friday (April 24), down 40.32 points or 0.67% as the BSP's first rate hike since October 2023 weighed on rate-sensitive sectors. Intraday range: 5,941.32–6,000.26. Exchange volume of trades: 70,852 valued at ₱5.220 billion. Banks led the decline: BPI fell 3.5% to ₱92.10 and BDO dropped 2.3% to ₱115. Ayala Corp shed nearly 3% to ₱490 as management flagged a potential capex cut from ₱230 billion to ~₱180 billion. Energy was mixed: MER rose 0.6% to ₱641 on defensive positioning while ACEN slipped 1.1% to ₱2.81 despite its ASM RE pivot message. SCC gained 0.5% to ₱30.65 on elevated coal prices.

Foreign Trade — Friday April 24, 2026

Net Foreign (Day)	-$10.340M	April MTD	-$216.236M	YTD	-$35.811M

Global Funds Bought Friday 4/24: ICT CEB BDO EW AUB PNB MYNLD MER SGP CNVRG APX PX AT SCC SM SMPH ROCK PHR CREIT MRC.
Global Funds Sold Friday 4/24: RRHI BPI MBT CBC SECB ALI MEG AREIT MWC AP AC URC GTCAP AEV A JFC CNPF DITO GLO TEL WEB.

Foreign Buying: ₱2,559,007,004.
Foreign Selling: ₱3,187,119,120.
Net Foreign Selling: ₱628,112,115.
Total Foreign: ₱5,746,126,124.

52-Week Highs: CEI, EW, MAXS, PSE.
52-Week Lows: ALI, BPI, KEEPR, PBB, PHN, PIZZA, SLI.
RSI 70 Overbought: PHR, EW, DITO, LSC, ASLAG, IS.
RSI 30 Oversold: GMA7, ABS, KEEPR.

NEWS, ANALYSIS & INVESTING INSIGHT

DA Market Securities x InvestaTrade Partnership	—	ANNOUNCEMENT

DA Market Securities officially partners with Investagrams to bring more powerful, accessible, and seamless investing experiences to Filipino traders. This collaboration marks a significant step forward in empowering investors with greater opportunities in the Philippine equity market — combining InvestaTrade's platform reach with DAMS's research-driven investment approach. (Source: DA Market Securities)

Stance: 🟢 POSITIVE — Broadens DA Market Securities client reach and reinforces the Employing Intelligent Investing mission through enhanced digital distribution.

BSP — Bangko Sentral ng Pilipinas — Rate Hike Cycle	4.50%	MACRO ALERT

The BSP raised its policy rate by 25 bps to 4.5% on April 23 — its first hike since October 2023 — as the Iran war's oil shock drives inflation expectations sharply higher. Deutsche Bank and ANZ Research both expect two additional 25-bp hikes (June 18 and August 27) to bring the terminal rate to 5.0% this year. The BSP now forecasts inflation averaging 6.3% in 2026 and 4.3% in 2027, both above its 2–4% target. Governor Remolona signaled a "front-loaded" approach to rein in second-round effects. The peso slipped 0.5% to ₱60.76/$ on Friday, reflecting growth worries and BSP's limited intervention signal. (Source: BusinessWorld, April 27)
Analysis: The pivot from easing to tightening is the most significant macro regime change since the pandemic. A 5.0% terminal rate compresses real estate affordability (directly impacting ALI, SMPH, MEG, RLC), raises corporate borrowing costs, and pressures bank NIMs as credit quality deteriorates. However, the rate hike cycle supports the peso and anchors inflation expectations — both necessary conditions for capital market stability.

Stance: 🔴 MACRO HEADWIND — Rate-sensitive sectors (property, consumer discretionary) face the most direct earnings pressure. Defensive names (utilities, staples, REITs with locked-in leases) are relatively insulated.

AC — Ayala Corp.	₱490.00	MONITOR

Ayala Corp. CEO Cezar Consing told shareholders that all business units will be "resilient" in 2026, though the conglomerate is cutting its capex target from ₱220–230 billion to approximately ₱180 billion — in line with 2025 levels. The real estate segment faces the most pressure from BSP rate hikes, though recurring leasing income provides partial offset. ACEN has scaled back its 2030 capacity target to 15 GW from 20 GW. AC Mobility expects profitability in 2026 on surging BYD EV sales. AC shares fell nearly 3% on Friday to ₱490. (Source: BusinessWorld, Philstar, InsiderPH, April 24–27)
Analysis: Ayala's pivot from growth to resilience is the right strategic call in a stagflationary environment. The capex trim preserves optionality while the conglomerate's diversified earnings base (BPI, Globe, ACEN, ALI) provides multiple levers. The AC Mobility EV bright spot and healthcare profitability are underappreciated positives. The key risk is whether the P65B core profit target for 2026 remains achievable.

Stance: 🟡 MONITOR — Resilience-first strategy is capital-protective. Watch for capex guidance update and Q1 earnings for

calibration.

BPI — Bank of the Philippine Islands	**₱92.10**	**MONITOR**

BPI shares plunged 3.5% on Friday to ₱92.10 — a new 52-week low — as the BSP rate hike amplified concerns about rising credit costs and an NPL uptick in Q1 2026. Net foreign selling reached ₱245.8M on the session. The banking sector is under dual pressure: the rate hike raises funding costs while the oil-driven economic slowdown feeds through to corporate and consumer credit quality. System-level NPL ratio rose to 3.33% in February. RSI is now in oversold territory below 30. (Source: BusinessWorld, PSE DQR)
Analysis: BPI's strong provisioning coverage provides a meaningful buffer, but the trajectory matters more than the level. If NPL formation accelerates through Q2 as fuel prices feed into transport and SME stress, credit cost provisions could compress earnings growth materially.

Stance: 🟡 MONITOR — Solid fundamentals but credit cost trajectory and rate sensitivity are the key risks. Do not add until NPL trend stabilizes.

ACEN — ACEN Corp.	**₱2.81**	**MONITOR**

ACEN President Eric Francia warned that a "renewables-only" strategy is insufficient for the Philippines' energy security. Coal faces mounting difficulties including restricted financing and declining social acceptance. ACEN targets 7 GW by 2027 and has earmarked P80B in capex for 2026. FY2025 net income fell 60% to P3.8B. The company is evaluating a fresh equity raise within the next 6–12 months. ACEN closed at ₱2.81 on April 24, down 1.06%. (Source: Manila Bulletin, BusinessWorld, InsiderPH)
Analysis: The energy crisis accelerates customer demand for RE contracts but pressures short-term earnings through volatile spot prices and supply chain cost inflation. The potential equity raise is dilutive risk. Execution on Palauig 2, SanMar Solar, and Monsoon Wind projects is the key to earnings normalization.

Stance: 🟡 MONITOR — Long-term thesis intact but near-term dilution risk and weak spot markets weigh. Wait for clarity on equity raise timing.

SMC — San Miguel Corp.	**₱71.50**	

Two positive developments: (1) The CTA En Banc upheld a tax refund exceeding ₱1 billion for San Miguel Brewery (SMB) on 2020 excise tax collections. (2) SMGP allocated ₱4.49B from its P30B bond issuance for hydropower and solar RE investments, with P6.9B for debt refinancing. SMGP's three-series bonds (2031, 2033, 2036) demonstrate strong capital market access despite elevated rates. (Source: BusinessWorld, April 27)
Analysis: The SMB tax refund is a direct one-time cash flow boost. SMGP's RE capex deployment signals diversification away from fossil fuel concentration. The P30B bond issuance at elevated yields reflects confidence in SMC's credit profile.

MWC / MYNLD — Manila Water / Maynilad	**₱42.80 / ₱21.15**	**MONITOR**

Metro Manila's water concessionaires are ramping up supply augmentation after PAGASA warned of a possible El Niño by midyear. MWSS directed Maynilad and Manila Water to reactivate deepwells, optimize treatment plants, and deploy emergency water tankers. Manila Water's Upper Wawa Dam (710 MLD capacity) strengthens long-term resilience. Maynilad is advancing a 200-ML reservoir at La Mesa and 40-ML reservoir in Valenzuela. Both are pushing "New Water" programs converting treated wastewater into potable water. (Source: BusinessWorld, GMA News, Manila Times)

Stance: 🟡 MONITOR — Defensive utility names with regulated revenue. El Niño risk manageable. MWC's Wawa Dam is a long-term structural positive.

FISCAL — Government Spending Cuts — DBM NBC 602	**—**	**MACRO ALERT**

The DBM issued NBC 602, mandating all government agencies to implement a minimum 20% reduction in discretionary spending. Savings to be redirected to UPLIFT (Unified Package for Livelihoods, Industry, Food, and Transport). The DBM estimates ₱12.8B to ₱25.6B in savings from March to December 2026. Education, health, and social protection are exempt. Major infrastructure projects may be suspended. (Source: BusinessWorld, Manila Bulletin, PIA)

Stance: 🔴 MACRO HEADWIND — Reduced government capex is negative for infra and construction names. Defensive sectors are relatively insulated.

MACRO — BSP Business Expectations Survey — March 2026	**CI: -24.3%**	**MACRO ALERT**

Business confidence plunged to -24.3% in March 2026, from +8.2% in February — the weakest in over 25 years (since Q4 2001). The quarter-ahead CI also turned negative at -17.3%. Firms cited the Iran war's impact on fuel costs, slower consumer spending, and tightening credit. Financial condition index: -24.9%. Hiring intentions turned negative for the first time. Consumer sentiment less pessimistic at -15.8% (Q1) but

quarter- and year-ahead outlook deteriorated. (Source: BSP BES, BusinessWorld, Philstar, Xinhua)

Stance: 🔴 MACRO HEADWIND — Stagflationary environment. Prioritize balance sheet quality and recurring revenue visibility.

PSEi Component Stocks

PSEi Stock	4/23/2026	4/24/2026	%Chg
AC	505	490	-2.97%
ACEN	2.84	2.81	-1.06%
AEV	28.95	28.5	-1.55%
ALI	16.34	16.1	-1.47%
AREIT	39.95	39.8	-0.38%
BDO	117.7	115	-2.29%
BPI	95.4	92.1	-3.46%
CBC	64	63.95	-0.08%
CNPF	31.5	31.5	+0.00%
CNVRG	12.66	12.5	-1.26%
DMC	10	9.9	-1.00%
EMI	15.32	15.28	-0.26%
GLO	1650	1648	-0.12%
GTCAP	497	492	-1.01%
ICT	710	700	-1.41%
JFC	163.4	162.8	-0.37%
JGS	27.45	27.1	-1.28%
LTG	15	14.9	-0.67%
MBT	67.1	67.5	+0.60%
MER	637.5	641	+0.55%
MONDE	6.6	6.68	+1.21%
PGOLD	42.8	42.5	-0.70%
PLUS	14.94	14.8	-0.94%
RCR	6.9	6.85	-0.72%
SCC	30.5	30.65	+0.49%
SM	627	624	-0.48%
SMC	72	71.5	-0.69%
SMPH	20.1	20	-0.50%
TEL	1282	1278	-0.31%
URC	61.15	61.5	+0.57%

PSE Dividend Yield Index (PSE DivY)

PSE DivY Stock	4/23/2026	4/24/2026	%Chg
AREIT	39.95	39.8	-0.38%
CBC	64	63.95	-0.08%
CREIT	3.49	3.45	-1.15%
DMC	10	9.9	-1.00%
DNL	3.67	3.56	-3.00%
GLO	1650	1648	-0.12%
LTG	15	14.9	-0.67%
MBT	67.1	67.5	+0.60%
MER	637.5	641	+0.55%
MREIT	13.92	13.8	-0.86%
NIKL	4.89	4.85	-0.82%
OGP	34.55	34.3	-0.72%
PGOLD	42.8	42.5	-0.70%
RCR	6.9	6.85	-0.72%
RLC	17.78	17.6	-1.01%
RRHI	46.45	46.2	-0.54%
SCC	30.5	30.65	+0.49%
SGP	21.95	22	+0.23%
TEL	1282	1278	-0.31%
URC	61.15	61.5	+0.57%

PSE MidCap Index

PSE MidCap Stock	4/23/2026	4/24/2026	%Chg
AGI	9.01	8.9	-1.22%
APX	17.22	17	-1.28%
AUB	42.1	42.2	+0.24%
BLOOM	2.02	2	-0.99%
COSCO	6.72	6.65	-1.04%
DNL	3.67	3.56	-3.00%
GSMI	274	273.4	-0.22%
KEEPR	1.92	1.9	-1.04%
MEG	2.11	2.08	-1.42%
MREIT	13.92	13.8	-0.86%
MWC	42.85	42.8	-0.12%
NIKL	4.89	4.85	-0.82%
OGP	34.55	34.3	-0.72%
PNB	59.5	59.55	+0.08%
RLC	17.78	17.6	-1.01%
RRHI	46.45	46.2	-0.54%
SECB	65.4	65.95	+0.84%

SEVN	34	33.8	-0.59%
SGP	21.95	22	+0.23%
WLCON	6.33	6.25	-1.26%

SMARTWATCH — COVERAGE UNIVERSE SNAPSHOT

Ticker	4/24 Close	4/23 Close	%Chg	Stance	Note
MER	641	637.5	+0.55%	**ACCUM**	MPower STT GDC 10yr RE deal; BSP hike neutral for utilities
ACEN	2.81	2.84	-1.06%	**MONITOR**	RE-only risky per Francia; P80B capex; equity raise under eval
SCC	30.65	30.5	+0.49%	**ACCUM**	Coal elevated; foreign net buyer Friday
FPH	—	—	—	**GOVERN**	ASM deferred; Lopez family legal dispute; loan covenant risk
GLO	1,648	1,650	-0.12%	**ACCUM**	Perpetual buyback $426M + Candle Cable; balance sheet de-risked
TEL	1,278	1,282	-0.31%	**MONITOR**	Bayad consolidation; Candle Cable consortium
JFC	162.8	163.4	-0.37%	**ACCUM**	5.5-yr low; MSCI risk; fundamentals intact — buy dip
CNPF	31.5	31.5	0.00%	**ACCUM**	FY2025 +11%; volume-driven; defensive staple
PGOLD	42.5	42.8	-0.70%	**MONITOR**	Defensive staples; oil shock beneficiary
URC	61.5	61.15	+0.57%	**MONITOR**	Foreign net seller; macro headwinds on discretionary
AC	490	505	-2.97%	**MONITOR**	Capex cut to ~P180B; resilience over growth; BPI drag
ALI	16.10	16.34	-1.47%	**MONITOR**	Leasing pivot; Laurean pause; P200K sqm retail expansion
AREIT	39.80	39.95	-0.38%	**ACCUM**	Near base support; ~7% yield; weekly RSI oversold
MREIT	13.80	13.92	-0.86%	**ACCUM**	Wave 4 pending; e27 hub; portfolio diversification; ~7% yield
BPI	92.1	95.4	-3.46%	**MONITOR**	NPL rising; BSP hike hits RE lending; RSI oversold; 52wk low
BDO	115	117.7	-2.29%	**MONITOR**	Foreign net seller; systemic NPL trend
MBT	67.5	67.1	+0.60%	**MONITOR**	Foreign net seller; provisioning watch
SMC	71.5	72	-0.69%	**ACCUM**	CTA P1B refund SMB; SMGP P4.49B RE; P30B bonds
MWC	42.80	42.85	-0.12%	**MONITOR**	El Niño prep; Upper Wawa Dam 710 MLD capacity
SMPH	20.0	20.1	-0.50%	**ACCUM**	Cebu Seaside Arena Q2; integrated model defensive
CEB	—	32.00	—	**REDUCE**	Dubai suspended to May-end; fuel surcharge Level 19
PLUS	14.80	14.94	-0.94%	**ACCUM**	SA licenses; Brazil H1; Sportradar SIE

🟢 **ACCUMULATE** 🟡 **MONITOR** 🔴 **AVOID** GOVERN = Governance Watch

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